

TIP 1: While creating new shapes, deselect the layer and then click on the shape tool again and create a new shape. This will ensure that the 2 shapes are on 2 different layers. If you do not do this, they will be in the same layer by default. This will make it very difficult to modify individual shapes in the future and the whole layer will start getting affected.

TIP 2: To create even sided rectangles or squares, hold down the Shift key while making a rectangle using the rectangle shape builder and you will see that it spreads out evenly as a Square.

TIP 3: Similarly, if you want to make an even rounded ellipse or Circle, then hold down the Shift key, while making a shape with the Ellipse tool and you will see that it starts to form a Circle. This works with both the Ellipse tool and the Rounded Rectangle tool.

Using the Rounded Rectangle tool has an additional which we need to pay attention to and that is the tapering of the edges. This can conveniently be adjusted using the Up and Down arrow keys to increase or decrease the roundness of the edges respectively.

To quickly change the Shape selector without having to use the mouse, press 'Q'. Each instance of this will trigger it to a different shape and you can do this until you reach the desired shape. Similarly, the Polygon and Star shape can also be selected and click and drag to form the respective shape

EDITED SHAPES

The first tool we're going to use to create an edited shape is the Polygon shape tool. Select this tool and start making a shape. You may wonder, if it is a polygon tool, then how do you create a shape with varying number of edges. This can quite awesomely be done by the same old handy up and down arrow keys, again. Pressing the Up arrow key, will increase the number of sides and pressing the down arrow key will decrease the number of edges. Just try it out and get most mesmerised but how beautifully it shape shifts. This on its own can be made into a beautiful animation!

TIP 1: Holding Shift will straighten out any shape you're building.

TIP 2: Press 'V' to activate the selection tool instead of manually selecting it every time.

Let's create an edited shape with our shape builder tool. Once the shape is built, select the shape in the layer list. You will see an 'Add' option under the layer next to the contents. Upon expanding this list, you will see a bunch of other options including 'Rounded Corners'. Clicking on this will add this as a property under the object.